

was forced to drop out of school and give up her career plans, for which she blamed Ben. Then the additional pressure of an unexpected infant added to their financial problems.

After coaching a multitude of couples of all ages in circumstances nearly identical to Ben and Naomi's, I think I can say with some degree of certainty that the financial situation in which they found themselves was indicative of their lack of training and knowledge. They were not stupid—just ignorant. “A prudent man sees danger and takes refuge, but the simple keep going and suffer for it” (Proverbs 22:3).

Ben was living in a dream world and angering his wife as he did so. He refused to take responsibility for his decisions and tried to blame their problems on Naomi. If she went to work, he reasoned, their problems would be solved. If she had taken her birth control pills, she wouldn't have gotten pregnant. God directed the husband to protect and comfort his wife, but Ben tried to shift the blame to her and sneak around behind her back with his personal indulgences.